

New & Notable

Kingston DataTraveller ELITE PRIVACY

Your data vault on-the-go

Kingston's PRIVACY series of USB Flash drives has always stirred users' fancies. The drive we received for testing offered a very decent 2 GB. It's great in terms of design, build quality, and aesthetic appeal.

Once inserted into a USB port the drive gets detected, but you can't access data just yet. Instead, the Kingston software will autorun; the software is on the drive's system area, which cannot be formatted. The purpose of the software is password protection: only after the correct password has been entered will the drive become accessible. If the password is incorrect, the drive will not show up in Windows. The password can only be reset by formatting the drive!

Data transfer rate is better than the other drives we've tested. The DataTraveller ELITE PRIVACY is perfect for moving large amounts of data to and fro, but Rs 8,500 is a little expensive.

Company **A A Infoways**
Price **Rs 8,500**
Phone **011-26442261**
E-mail **info@infoways.com**
Web site **www.kingston.com**

Rating 

Tech-Com DSC-512X PLUS

Just a good camera

The DSC-512X PLUS camera may not look extraordinary, but it has a 7-megapixel CCD with 3x optical zoom. The display is a 2-inch colour TFT LCD. There's no viewfinder, so shooting in bright sunlight is somewhat difficult. Inbuilt memory is only 32 MB but thankfully, an SD/MMC card slot is provided. The camera supports the PictBridge interface.

The photos we clicked were crisp, and the colour vivid. Video shooting is supported. The inbuilt flash is good enough even for pitch-dark conditions.

Tech-Com has also provided four games with the camera, and the software package includes Ulead Photo Explorer 8 SE. The bottom-line—a decent buy!



Company **Shree Sagarmatha Dist Pvt Ltd**
Price **Rs 7,990**
Phone **011-26428541**
E-mail **contact@techcomindia.com**
Web site **www.techcomindia.com**

Rating 

Leadtek Winfast PX7900GTX

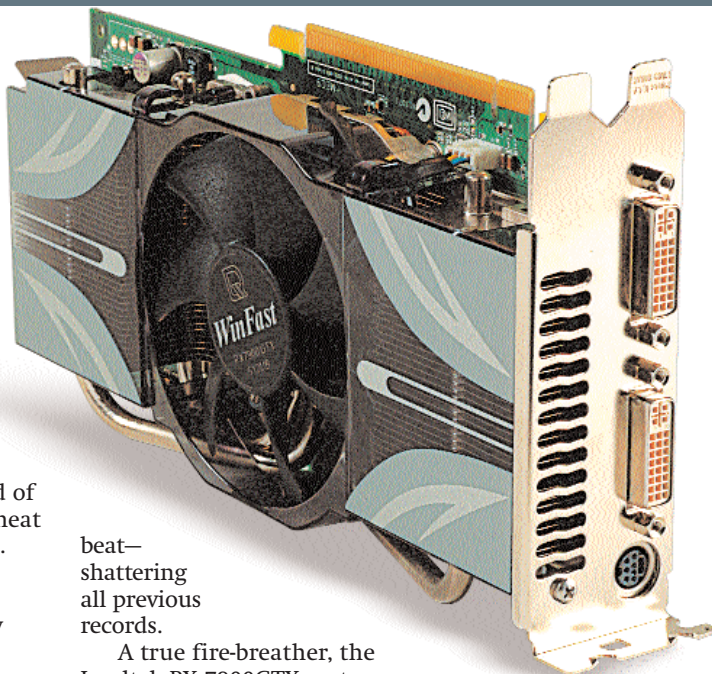
A monster of a graphics card

This GPU is the latest from NVIDIA. It's based on NVIDIA's newest and fastest 7900GTX chipset. It features the same 24-pixel pipeline architecture of the 7800GTX series, but with a lower transistor count, meaning significantly lower heat dissipation. The low transistor count also means NVIDIA could up the clock speed, which they haven't missed out on.

The Leadtek PX7900GTX features a 650 MHz core and 512 MB of GDDR3 memory @ 1600 MHz. Add to that full Direct X SM 3.0 compliance and HDR support, and you have a monster of a card on your hands! And the card does look monstrous, thanks in part to the huge heat sink, which has cooling pipes dissipating heat away from that supercharged core. One serious accomplishment here is the temperatures, which were well in check—easily within limits for a card of this calibre. The memory is also actively cooled via the heat sink, which is integrated with a large-diameter slow fan. Noise levels are tolerable.

Apart from the driver CD and free software, the card comes bundles with a full version of Serious Sam 2, a new game, which should give this card an easy workout. Also bundled are the composite cables, and the DVI to D-Sub adapter; the card comes with two DVI-I connectors, so if your monitor has only D-Sub, you will need to use this.

Performance-wise, this board is no slouch! 3D Mark 2005 put up scores in excess of 11000—an all-time high among all the cards we've tested! We started up DOOM 3 and were greeted with a straight 100+ fps score. To make things interesting we cranked up the resolution while enabling full AF and AA, and even at these settings the card didn't miss a



beat—shattering all previous records.

A true fire-breather, the Leadtek PX 7900GTX costs a whopping Rs 35,000. Premium products don't come cheap, now, do they!

Company **Top Notch Infotronics (I) Pvt Ltd**
Price **Rs 35,000**
Phone **044-26616201/202**
E-mail **zebronics@zebronics.net**
Web site **www.leadtek.com**

Rating 